



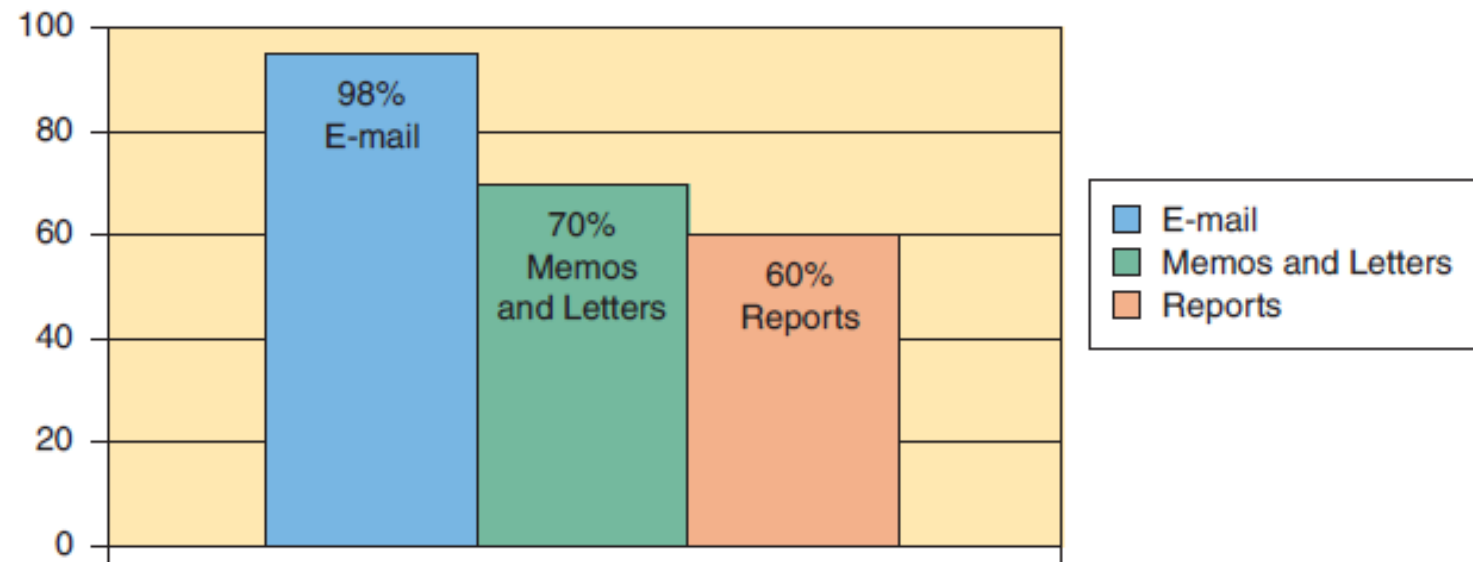
Routine Correspondence

Memos, Letters, E-Mails Messages,
Instant Messages and Text Messages



The Importance
of Memos,
Letters, E-Mails,
Instant
Messages, and
Text Messages

FIGURE 6.1 Percentage of Employees Who Consider E-mail, Memos, Letters, and Reports "Extremely Important"



The Differences Among Routine Communication Channels

Characteristics	Memos	Letters	Email	IM/ TM
Destination	Internal: correspondence written to colleagues within a company.	External: correspondence written outside the business.	Internal and external: correspondence written to friends, acquaintances, coworkers within a company, and clients and vendors.	Internal and external: correspondence written to friends, acquaintances, coworkers within a company, and clients and vendors.
Format	Identification lines include “Date”, “To”, “From” and “Subject”. The message follows.	Includes letterhead address, date, reader’s address, salutation, text, complimentary close, and signatures.	Identification lines: To and Subject. The date and From are computer generated. Options include cc (complimentary copy), forwarding the email message to others and replying to numerous readers.	No Format

The Differences Among Routine Communication Channels

Characteristics	Memos	Letters	Email	IM/ TM
Audience	Generally high tech or low tech, mostly business colleagues.	Generally low tech and lay readers, such as vendors, clients, stakeholders, and stockholders.	Multiple readers due to the internal or external nature of e-mail.	Multiple readers due to the internal and external nature of IM and TM.
Topic	Generally, topics related to the internal corporate information; abbreviations and acronyms often allowed.	Generally, topics related to vendor, client, stakeholder, and stockholder interest; abbreviations and acronym usually defined.	A wide range of diverse topics determined by the audience.	A wide range of diverse topics determined by the audience.

The Differences Among Routine Communication Channels

Characteristics	Memos	Letters	Email	IM/ TM
Complexity and length of communication	Memos usually are limited to a page of text. If you need to write longer correspondence and develop a topic in more detail, you might consider using a different communication channel, such as a short report.	Letters are usually limited to a page of text, though you might write a two-or-three-page report using a letter format. If you need to develop a topic in greater detail than can be conveyed in one to three pages, you might want to use a different communication channel, such as a longer, formal report.	An effective e-mail message usually is limited to one viewable screen (requiring no scrolling) or two screens. Email, generally, is not the best communication channel to use for complex information or long correspondence. If your topic demands more depth that can be conveyed in a report.	IM and TM are brief communication channels. Text messages must be limited to 160 characters. The typical size of an instant message is around 200 characters. Generally, the maximum size for mobile messages is approximately 400 characters.

The Differences Among Routine Communication Channels

Characteristics	Memos	Letters	Email	IM/ TM
Tone	Informal due to peer audience.	More formal due to audience of vendors, clients, stakeholders, stockholders.	A wide range of tone due to diverse audience. Usually informal when written to friends, formal to co-workers, more formal to management or external readers.	Very informal due to the limits placed on size.

The Differences Among Routine Communication Channels

Characteristics	Memos	Letters	Email	IM/ TM
Attachments or enclosures	Hard-copy attachments can be stapled to the memo. Complimentary copies (CC) can be sent to other readers.	Additional information can be enclosed within the envelope. Complimentary copies (CC) can be sent to other readers.	Computer word processing files, HTML files and Web links, PDF files, RTF files or downloadable graphics can be attached to e-mail. CC can be sent to other readers.	Attachments can be sent using IM. You can send photo attachments with TM. However, sending file attachments with TM is limited.
Delivery time	Determined by a company's in-house mail procedure.	Determined by the destination (within the city, state, or country). Letters could be delivered within three days but may take more than one week.	Often instantaneous, usually within minutes. Delays can be caused by system malfunctions or excessively large attachments.	Instantaneous

The Differences Among Routine Communication Channels

Characteristics	Memos	Letters	Email	IM/ TM
Security	If a company's mail delivery system is reliable, the memo will be placed in the reader's mailbox. Then, what the reader sees in the hard-copy page will be exactly what the writer wrote. Security depends on the ethics of co-workers and whether the memo was sent in an envelope.	It depends on a country's privacy laws.	E-mail systems are not secure. It can be tampered with, read by others, and sent to many people. E-mail stays within a company's computer backup system and is the property of the company. Therefore, e-mail is not private.	The same problems with e-mail security exist with TM/ IM.

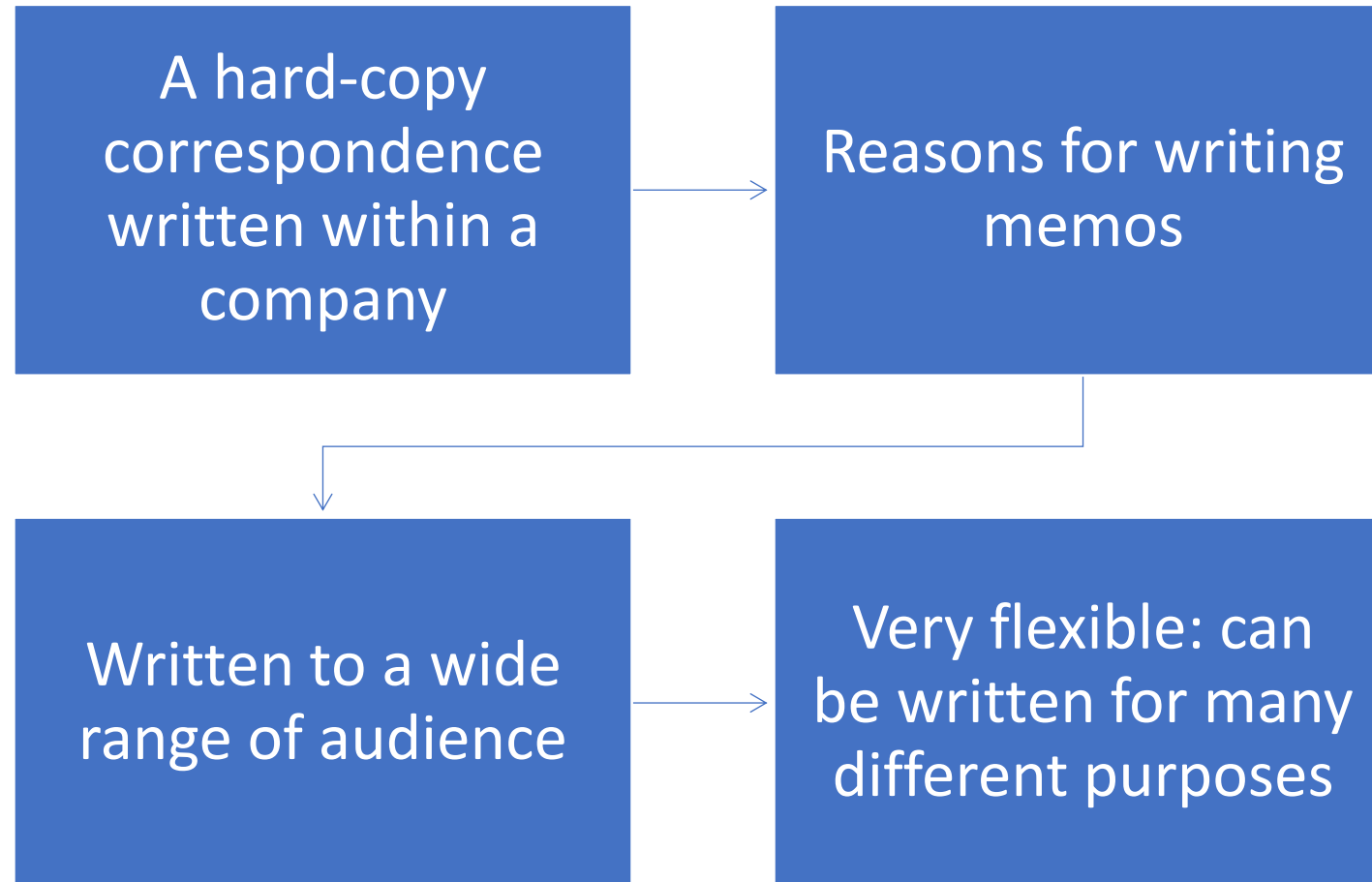
Why write a memo? Haven't memos been replaced by e-mail?

Q: Why write a memo? Haven't memos been replaced by e-mail?

A: E-mail is rapidly overtaking memos in the workplace, but employees still write memos for the following reasons:

1. Not all employees work in offices or have access to computers. Many employees who work in warehouses or in the field cannot easily access an e-mail account. They must depend on hard-copy documentation like memos.
2. Not all companies have e-mail. This may be hard to believe in the twenty-first century, but still it's a fact. These companies depend on hard-copy documentation like memos.
3. Many unions demand that hard-copy memos be posted on walls, in break rooms, in offices, and elsewhere, to ensure that all employees have access to important information. Sometimes, unions even demand that employees initial the posted memos, thus acknowledging that the memos have been read.
4. Some information cannot be transmitted electronically via e-mail. A bank we've worked with, for example, sends hard-copy cancelled checks as attachments to memos. They cannot send the actual cancelled check via e-mail.
5. E-mail messages are very easy to disregard. We get so many e-mail messages (many of them spam) that we tend to quickly delete them. Memos, in contrast, make more of an official statement. People might take hard-copy memos more seriously than e-mail messages.

Memo



Reasons for Writing Memos, E-Mails & Letters

Documentation-
expenses, incidents,
hiring, firings, problems
encountered reallocations
of staff or equipment

Confirmation-a meeting
agenda, date, time and
location, conclusions, cost
etc.

Procedures- how to set up
accounts, use a software,
machine etc.

Recommendations-
reasons to purchase new
items, fire or hire
personnel etc.

Feasibility-Study the
possibility of changes in
the workplace

Status-daily, weekly,
monthly, quarterly,
biannually, yearly
statements about
progress

Directive (delegation of
responsibility)- Informing
subordinate about their
tasks

Inquiry-about upcoming
procedures/ products

Cover-prefacing an
internal proposal, long
report and other
attachments

Criteria For Writing Memos

Memo identification lines (Date, To, From and Subject)

Introduction

- one /two sentences on what/ why

Discussion

- Detailed development about what you want to say

Conclusion

- State what is next, when this will occur, and why the date is important

Audience recognition

Appropriate memo style and tone

- Simple words, short sentences, specific details, and highlighting techniques

FIGURE 6.5 Cover Memo Prefacing Attachments

MEMO

CompuMed

Date: November 11, 2012

To: CompuMed Management

From: Bill Baker, Human Resources Director

Subject: Information about Proposed Changes to Employee Benefits Package

As of January 1, 2013, CompuMed will change insurance carriers. This will affect all 5,000 employees' benefits packages. I have attached a proposal, including the following:

- | | |
|--|-----------|
| 1. Reasons for changing from our current carrier | page 2 |
| 2. Criteria for our selection of a new insurance company | pages 3–4 |
| 3. Monthly cost for each employee | pages 5–6 |
| 4. Overall cost to CompuMed | page 7 |
| 5. Benefits derived from the new healthcare plan | page 8 |

Please review the proposal, survey your employees' responses to our suggestions, and provide your feedback. We need your input by December 1, 2012. This will give the Human Resources Department time to consider your suggestions and work with insurance companies to meet employee needs.

Enclosure: Proposal

MEMO CHECKLIST

- | | |
|--|---|
| _____ 1. Does the memo contain identification lines (Date, To, From, and Subject)? | _____ 6. Are highlighting techniques used effectively for document design? |
| _____ 2. Does the subject line contain a topic and a focus? | _____ 7. Is the memo concise? |
| _____ 3. Does the introduction clearly state <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Why this memo has been written?• What topic the memo is discussing? | _____ 8. Is the memo clear, <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Achieving specificity of detail?• Answering reporter's questions? |
| _____ 4. Does the body explain exactly what you want to say? | _____ 9. Does the memo recognize audience, defining acronyms or abbreviations where necessary for various levels of readers (high tech, low tech, and lay)? |
| _____ 5. Does the conclusion <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Tell when you plan a follow-up or when you want a response?• Explain why this dated action is important? | _____ 10. Did you avoid grammatical errors? Errors will hurt your professionalism. See Appendix A for grammar rules and exercises. |

Activity : Rewrite a Poor Memo

DATE: Feb 9
TO: All Staff
FROM: HR
SUBJECT: Office timings

Hey everyone,
We are changing office timings from next week. New timing will be from 9 AM to 6 PM. Hope this is fine with everyone. Let us know if there is any issue.

**Thanks,
HR**

- **Questions:**

1. Identify **at least 3 issues** in this memo.
2. Rewrite it professionally.

Answer Key

DATE: February 9, 2025

TO: All Employees

FROM: Human Resources Department

SUBJECT: Update on Office Timings

Please be informed that, effective next week, our official office hours will change to **9:00 AM – 6:00 PM**. Kindly make necessary adjustments to your schedule accordingly.

If you have any concerns, feel free to reach out to the HR department.

Thank you for your cooperation.

Why is E-mail Important?



Time



Convenience



Internal/ External



Cost



Documentation

Reasons For Writing E-mail Messages

Directive- Tell to complete a task

Cover/ transmittal-
Inform about attachments

Documentation-
Report on expenses, incidents, accidents etc.

Confirmation- Inform a reader about meeting agenda, date, time, location etc.

Procedures- How to set up new accounts, operate a machine, use a software

Recommendations-
Provide reasons to purchase new equipment, hire personnel, contract with new providers

Feasibility- Study the possibility of changes in the workplace (practices, procedures, locations)

Status-daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, biannually, yearly statements about progress

Inquiry – Ask questions about upcoming procedures/ products/ tasks

Techniques For Writing Effective E- mail Messages

Recognize

- Recognize Your Audience

Identify

- Identify Yourself

Provide

- Provide an Effective Subject Line

Keep

- Keep Your E-mail Message Brief

Organize

- Organize Your E-mail Messages

Use

- Use Highlighting Techniques Sparingly

Proofread

- Proofread Your E-mail Message

Make

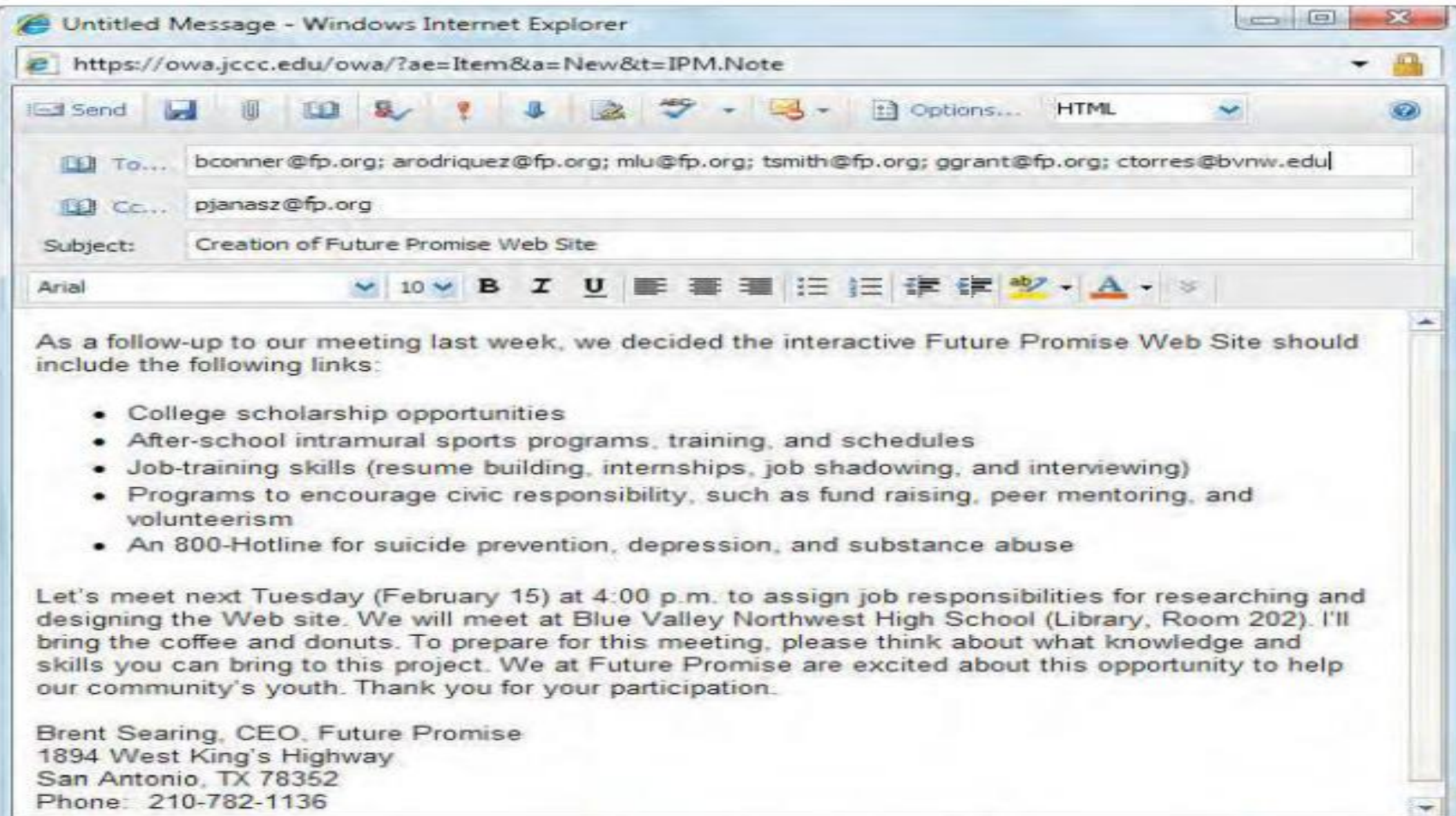
- Make Hard Copies For Future Reference

Be

- Be Careful When Sending Attachments

Practice

- Practice Netiquette



E-MAIL CHECKLIST

- ____ 1. Does the e-mail use the correct address?
- ____ 2. Have you identified yourself? Provide a sig (signature) line.
- ____ 3. Did you provide an effective subject line? Include a topic and a focus.
- ____ 4. Have you effectively organized your e-mail? Consider including the following:
 - Opening sentence(s) telling why you are writing and what you are writing about.
 - Discussion unit with itemized points telling what exactly the e-mail is discussing.
 - Concluding sentence(s) summing up your e-mail message or telling your audience what to do next.
- ____ 5. Have you used highlighting techniques sparingly?
 - Avoid boldface, italics, color, or underlining.
 - Use asterisks for bullets, numbers, and double spacing for access.
- ____ 6. Did you practice netiquette?
 - Be polite, courteous, and professional.
 - Don't flame.
 - Don't overuse textese.
- ____ 7. Is the e-mail concise?
- ____ 8. Did you identify and limit the size of attachments?
 - Tell your reader(s) if you have attached files and what types of files are attached (Ppt, PDF, RTF, Word, etc.).
 - Zip large files.
- ____ 9. Does the memo recognize audience?
 - Define acronyms or abbreviations where necessary.
 - Consider a diverse audience (factoring in issues, such as multiculturalism or gender).
- ____ 10. Did you avoid grammatical errors?

Activity 1: Below is an email with several mistakes in formatting, tone, and professionalism. Identify and correct them.

Subject: Important info!!!!

Hey,

I need u to send me the report ASAP. The boss is asking, and I totally forgot about it. Plz do it fast.

Thx,
John

• **Questions:**

1. Identify **at least 5 mistakes** in the email.
2. Rewrite the email in a professional tone.

Answer Key

- **Subject:** Urgent: Request for Monthly Report

Dear Mr Richard,

I hope you are doing well.

Could you please send me the monthly report today, 13th February 2025, by 3:30 pm? Our manager has requested it, and I would appreciate your prompt assistance.

Thank you for your help.

**Best regards,
John**

Activity 2: Identify the Purpose of a Memo

- Read the following scenarios and decide if they require a **memo or an email**.

1. Announcing a new office dress code policy.

- Memo/email

2. Requesting an update from a supplier.

- Email

3. Informing all employees about a fire drill.

- Memo/email

4. Sending a reminder about an upcoming meeting to one person.

- Email

Activity 3

- **Scenario:** You need to inform a colleague about a change in the meeting schedule. Write a **formal** email.

Answer Key

To: Richard.robet@gmail.com

Subject: Rescheduled Meeting Notification

Dear Mr. Richard,

I am writing to inform you that our meeting scheduled for Wednesday at 2:00 PM has been rescheduled to Thursday, 13th February 2025 at 3:00 PM in the meeting room# 11. Please let me know if this timing works for you.

**Best regards,
Affaq Qamar**

Assistant Manager